

Haryana

New Strides in Agriculture

Agriculture contributes 26.4 per cent to the State's Gross Domestic Product.

Haryana along with Punjab is the food basket of India. It is the second largest contributor of wheat and third largest supplier of rice to the central pool. Haryana has achieved an all time high foodgrains production of 108.56 lakh metric tonnes during 2008-09 whereas at the time of inception of the State the production foodgrains was just 25.92 lakh tonnes.

The State Government has taken many landmark decisions this year for the welfare of the farming community, which include reduction of interest on crop loans, waiving off arrears of power bills, implementation of National Agriculture Insurance Scheme, reduction in electric tariff by 50 per cent for horticulture and fisheries and declaration of highest sugarcane support price in the country of Rs 185 per quintal. The Government has introduced the loan waiver scheme that would benefit more than seven lakh farmers of the State to the tune of Rs 2,189 crore. In a big relief to farmers the government has waived electricity bills worth Rs 1,600 crore for rural domestic and tubewell category consumers.

The UPA government has further increased the MSP of wheat at Rs. 1,080 per quintal, an increase of Rs. 80 over the past year's MSP. MSP of barley and gram has been fixed at Rs. 680 and Rs. 1,730 per quintal respectively. MSP of gram and lentil have been hiked to Rs. 1,730 and Rs. 1,870 a quintal respectively.

As a major breakthrough the government has increased the compensation amount for crop damage due to hailstorms from Rs. 1,000, Rs. 1,500 and Rs. 2,000 per acre to Rs. 3,000, Rs. 4,000 and Rs. 5,000 for wheat and rice and for other type of crops it has been increased to Rs. 2,000, Rs. 3,000 and Rs. 4,000. ■



Facts Tell A Glorious Tale

- **Haryana has set a new record in wheat, paddy and cotton production. During 2008-09 food grain production alone has increased to 108.56 lakh tonnes.**
- **Under the ambitious Loan Waiver Scheme for farmers the Haryana Government has waived off the loans of Rs. 2189.82 crore benefitting 7, 09,385 people in the State.**
- **The Government has provided concession to the tune of Rs. 4,000 crores to poor sections of the society; small farmers, artisans and employees. Out of this concession of Rs. 830 crores were given in co-operative sector alone.**
- **The interest rate on crop loan has been reduced from 11% to 7% by HARCOT bank in the State.**
- **Now the Farmers would not be arrested for the recovery of loan given by Co-operatives in the State.**
- **Computerisation of land record in all districts of Haryana has been implemented.**
- **The Haryana Government is paying a royalty of Rs. 30,000 per acre annually with an increase of Rs 1,000 every year for 33 years to those farmers whose land has been acquired for setting up Special Economic Zones. This grant is in addition to the compensation given to the farmers.**
- **The Government is paying a royalty of Rs.15, 000 per acre annually with an increase of Rs. 500 every year for 33 years to those farmers whose land has been acquired by the government for other public purposes. This is in addition to the compensation given by the State.**
- **The Government has reduced stamp duty by one percent for registration and transfer of property from 8% in urban areas and 6% in rural areas to 7% and 5% respectively.**